

INTENSIVE MAX GLUTE HYPERTROPHY

Description

The Intensive Max Glute Hypertrophy program is a full-body program aimed at building a well-rounded physique with emphasis on the gluteus musculature and secondary focus on hamstrings and delts.

Mid-range rep (hypertrophy) back squats are prioritized in Day 1 to emphasize technique and to continue building your lower body strength. Delts are prioritized earlier in the week on Day 2, as it is the main focus for upper body development of this program. American Deadlifts are included in Day 5, they are a combination between Romanian and conventional deadlifts.

Intensive Max Glute Hypertrophy is an RPE based program, meaning it is auto-regulated. Your progression is based on your ability to rate your exertion (proximity to failure) and your willingness to challenging yourself. Auto-regulated linear periodization is well-accepted at the best way to take advantage of the beginner stages of weight training. (This is an intermediate program in terms of difficulty, so I am confident it will challenge intermediate trainees, but it is aimed at those who have been training seriously for strength under 1 year and have room to progress at this rate.)

This program incorporates auto-regulation via a traditional rep-range approach. For RPE rep range sets, the goal is to choose the heaviest weight you can do for the low end of the rep range at the designated RPE. You would then progress with this weight until you can hit that weight for the top end of the rep range for two weeks before increasing the weight. Ex. Bicep curl W1 30 lbs 3x8, W2 2x9, 1x10 ... W4 3x10, W5 3x10, W6 increase to 35 lbs.

It's important to push yourself to your limits - what you previously felt was failure, may not be. Make the 3-4 sets count. Aim to PR each week by adding a rep on one or more sets, or by increasing the weight for one or all sets. Proper form is important, but expect form breakdown, visibly slow and shaky last 2-3 reps for all 'hypertrophy' (8+ reps) exercises. (This is different for specific strength work.)

Mind - Muscle Connection

Conscious neuromuscular recruitment, mind-muscle connection, is extremely important for building glutes (and rear delts). Although glutes are the largest muscle on the body and supposedly the most powerful, people are fairly sedentary growing up -- sitting on their butt for most of the day -- glutes tend to go silent and are resistant to activating. In my experience, the key to building glutes quickly is to focus on achieving mind-muscle connection on all glute-targeting exercises before you get to the working

sets. (Do a warm up or two with light weight, then increase the weight step-wise to challenge yourself but keep the glutes firing throughout the ROM and set.)

Schedule

- This program follows a 2 day on, 1 day off, 3 day on, 1 day off schedule.
- This is a guide, you may sometimes move rest days to better fit your schedule if necessary. Complete the sessions in order, avoid skipping sessions.
- The lower body prehab routine is specifically aimed at activating the glutes - getting them warmed up and firing before the training session.
- Please complete lower body prehab routines prior to lower body training sessions and likewise with upper body prehab and training.
- If any exercises are uncomfortable or painful for any reason, please skip them.
- Please stop immediately if you experience pain, shortness of breath, or feel faint at any point during your training.

Important Terms

RPE

RPE is a self-measure of how hard you're working and how exhausted your muscles are. It is a scale of 1-10, with 6-7 being a warm-up, 8 being 2-4 reps left in the tank before failure, 9 stopping one rep shy of complete failure and 10 is going to complete failure (minor form breakdown acceptable).

So if you are working with 4 sets of 8, RPE 8, you would choose a weight that allows you to work hard but not come too close to failure and you should be able to perform all reps with good form. RPE 9 you might struggle a bit on the last rep, but you could possibly do one more. You would then choose your working weight to match these parameters.

Video Demo Links

BACK SQUAT - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JftyKFFZho8>

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zoZWgTrZLd8>

PRELOADED BARBELL RDL - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=JCXUYuzwNrM>

PRELOADED BARBELL WALKING LUNGE -

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=0_9sJd9P8M0

CABLE GLUTE KICKBACK - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=doyY1MAWlxU>

SINGLE LEG PRONE LEG CURL - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1Tq3QdYUuHs>
LYING LEG RAISE - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xqTh6NqbAtM>
SEATED CALF PRESS MACHINE - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=W-NU8NUS8II>

SEATED INCLINE PRESS - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ig0NyNISce4> or
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8iPEnn-ltC8>
DB LATERAL RAISE - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3VcKaXpzqRo>
45° LAT PULL DOWN - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=up1ma6bfmQI> (but with
knee-securing pad)
SEATED CABLE ROW - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GZbfZ033f74>
DB REAR DELT FLYE - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ttvfGg9d76c>
WINDSHEILD WIPERS - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=arDUVmCzyhc>

SQUAT PRESS (OR LEG PRESS) -
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EgvWXZOXmml> (squat press machine)
CABLE SQUAT PULL THROUGH -
<https://www.instagram.com/p/BGz1KD4pdNV/?taken-by=bretcontreras1>
MACHINE HIP ABDUCTION - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2b97cvyH9sE>
ROMAN CHAIR CALF RAISES - <https://youtu.be/RasLp39fLLY?t=15m37s>

MACHINE HORIZONTAL ROW - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8MKGArs7w7c>
ROPE CABLE ROW - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Dq1D7OD64JE>
CABLE LATERAL RAISE - <https://youtu.be/FGU9j1P5L-w>
SINGLE-ARM BENT-OVER REAR DELT FLYE - <https://youtu.be/DAC4qmKv5o0?t=52s>
RUSSIAN TWIST - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pDTHSnoGoEc>

AMERICAN DEADLIFT - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OAVMj6GJwfY>
PRELOADED BARBELL STEP UP - <https://youtu.be/860722r7v2E?t=51s>
CABLE ROMANIAN DEADLIFT - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=9wWvRL9AKjs>
KNEELING LEG CURL - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=bb7H0WspSYw>
V-UP - https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=514sifgYn_k
SIDE CRUNCH - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CMJA332bfs0>

PREHABILITATION

ROBIN GALLANT
science based coaching



lower body

exercise	SETS	REPS	REST	NOTES	VIDEO LINK	TIME
SPIN BIKE	1	1	1	5 minutes moderate pace		6.0
SQUAT AND REACH	1	1	0	30-second hold	https://youtu.be/7XlVerHlUeIk?t=20s	0.1
STEP THROUGH	1	10	0	2-second hold each stride	https://youtu.be/YlhlrAlNags?t=16s	0.3
SUPINE STRAIGHT LEG RAISE	1	24	0	12 each, lie on back, raise leg up 1 foot and lower	https://youtu.be/Lu5b4ZPun7q	0.8
SIDE LYING HIP ABDUCTION	1	24	0	12 each, use glutes to raise leg up 1 foot and lower	https://youtu.be/qY92MjFfixQ	0.8
PRONE HIP EXTENSION	1	24	0	12 each, lie on stomach, contract glutes to lift and lower legs	https://youtu.be/Kl8bDB_BQj8	0.8
DYNAMIC LEG SWING	1	24	0	12 each, hold onto structure for support	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=8_-3xijBzVE	0.8
STATIC GLUTE STRETCH	2	10	0	2 sets of 10 sec hold, lying supine, hug left knee to right pec until slight stretch is felt		
QUADRUPED GLUTE KICKBACK	2	15	0	unweighted, lean forward, tuck knee to chest, mindfully contract glutes, kicking heel in arc towards the ceiling		
FIRE HYDRANT	2	12	0	12 each side, quadruped, knee bent 90*, hip abduction		0.8
total time						10.4

upper body

exercise	SETS	REPS	REST	NOTES		time
CONCEPT ROWER	1	1	1	5 minutes moderate pace		6.0
RESISTANCE BAND SHOULDER CIRCUMDUCTION	1	1	0	use linear resistance band	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=W-hONUIT2LD	0.0
RESISTANCE BAND EXTERNAL ROTATION	1	24	0	12 each side	https://youtu.be/1ug85y6KyXU?t=16s	0.8
RESISTANCE BAND PULL APART	1	12	0	protract shoulders, pronated grip	https://youtu.be/73Dm-j5wYlc	0.4
SHOULDER YTW	1	24	0	8 each	https://youtu.be/xjvnlgh9PN0?t=17s	0.8
ARM CIRCLE	1	24	0	12 each side	https://youtu.be/hP52EXTIzjA?t=43s	0.8
total time						8.8

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day one

	SETS	REPETITIONS	RPE	REST	1	2	3	4	5	NOTES
BACK SQUAT	2	6-8	7	1.0						wider than shoulder width stance, slight foot flare
	3	8-10	9	1.5						focus on ext. rotating at the hips on descent and ascent
PRELOADED BARBELL RDL	3	12-15	9	1.0						use straps if grip is limiting
PRELOADED BARBELL WALKING LUNGE	3	18-20	9	1.5						short strides, low bar or lean forward, all weight onto forward step
CABLE GLUTE KICKBACK	3	12-15	9	1.0						torso parallel to ground, if hamstrings too weak, strap around knee
SINGLE LEG PRONE LEG CURL	3	8-10	9	0.5						8 each leg, 8 both legs
LYING LEG RAISE	3	10-12	10	0.5						hold onto bench behind head for stability
SEATED CALF PRESS MACHINE	3	30	10	0.5						10 toes in, 10 parallel, 10 toes out, push thru pads of feet

take last set to failure

day two

	SETS	REPETITIONS	RPE	REST	1	2	3	4	5	NOTES
SEATED INCLINE PRESS	3	8-10	9	1.0						dumbbell or machine, your choice
A1. DB LATERAL RAISE	3	12	9	0.5						arms slightly bent, avoid shrugging
A2. BENT ARM DB LATERAL RAISE	3	3	9	0.5						bend arms to get 3 more reps to failure
45° LAT PULL DOWN	3	8-10	9	0.5						may do standing, exaggerated lean, wide grip to emphasis rear delts
SEATED CABLE ROW	3	10-12	9	0.5						v-bar grip attachment
DB REAR DELT FLYE	3	15-20	9	0.5						W-flye, backs of hands lead, elbows slightly bent
WINDSHEILD WIPERS	3	10-12	9	0.5						either hanging or on roman chair (ab/oblique exercise)

take last set to failure

day three

	SETS	REPETITIONS	RPE	REST	1	2	3	4	5	NOTES
SQUAT PRESS (OR LEG PRESS)	4	10-12	9	0.5						feet high on platform, wide stance, patience on concentric
CABLE SQUAT PULL THROUGH	2	10-12	9	0.5						warm up - patience on concentric, glutes move the weight, work the resistance up
	3	12-15	9	1.0						as above + 1 sec maximum contraction iso-hold at "lock-out"
A1. CABLE GLUTE KICKBACK	4	18-20	9	0.0						torso parallel to ground, if hamstrings too weak, strap around knee
A2. MACHINE HIP ABDUCTION	4	30	9	1.0						standing or seated
ROMAN CHAIR CALF RAISES	3	30		0.5						hold onto back of chair, lean hips back, push through pad of foot
OPTIONAL BRET'S GLUTE BURNOUT	3	1	10	0.0						https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fouQIVcMVI4

day four

	SETS	REPETITIONS	RPE	REST	1	2	3	4	5	NOTES
MACHINE HORIZONTAL ROW	3	10-12	9	0.5						machine of choice
BRADFORD PRESS	3	10-14	9	1.0						https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GEk3HtY9dCg
ROPE CABLE ROW	3	10-12	9	1.0						cable at eye level, lunge back from cable machine
CABLE LATERAL RAISE	3	10-12	9	1.0						step 1 foot out from machine, cable in front of body
SINGLE-ARM BENT-OVER REAR DELT FLY	3	12-15	9	0.5						cable machine
A1. LYING LEG RAISE	3	10-12	9	0.0						extend lower back to stretch abs before raising legs and then hips
A2. RUSSIAN TWIST	3	10-12	9	1.0						10 each side

take last set to failure

day five

	SETS	REPETITIONS	RPE	REST	1	2	3	4	5	NOTES
AMERICAN DEADLIFT	2	8	8	0.5						warm up, work the resistance up to working sets
	3	8-10	9	1.0						sit hips back, bend at the knees, contract glutes to lockout
PRELOADED BARBELL STEP UP	3	10-12	9	1.5						control the negative as best as possible - do not alt sides
CABLE PULL THROUGH	3	18-20	9	0.5						burn out sets
CABLE ROMANIAN DEADLIFT	3	12-15	9	0.5						set up stable box 6" from cable machine, use bicycle bar attachment
KNEELING LEG CURL	3	10-12	9	0.5						anteriorly tilt pelvis, curl out and away from body
V-UP	3	10-12	9	0.5						
SIDE CRUNCH	3	10-12	9	0.5						each side

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day one

	SETS	REPETITIONS	RPE	REST	1	2	3	4	5	NOTES
BACK SQUAT	2	6-8	7	1.0						wider than shoulder width stance, slight foot flare
	3	8-10	9	1.5						focus on ext. rotating at the hips on descent and ascent
PRELOADED BARBELL RDL	3	12-15	9	1.0						use straps if grip is limiting
PRELOADED BARBELL WALKING LUNGE	3	18-20	9	1.5						short strides, low bar or lean forward, all weight onto forward step
CABLE GLUTE KICKBACK	3	12-15	9	1.0						torso parallel to ground, if hamstrings too weak, strap around knee
SINGLE LEG PRONE LEG CURL	3	8-10	9	0.5						8 each leg, 8 both legs
LYING LEG RAISE	3	10-12	10	0.5						hold onto bench behind head for stability
SEATED CALF PRESS MACHINE	3	30	10	0.5						10 toes in, 10 parallel, 10 toes out, push thru pads of feet

take last set to failure

day two

	SETS	REPETITIONS	RPE	REST	1	2	3	4	5	NOTES
SEATED INCLINE PRESS	3	8-10	9	1.0						dumbbell or machine, your choice
A1. DB LATERAL RAISE	3	12	9	0.5						arms slightly bent, avoid shrugging
A2. BENT ARM DB LATERAL RAISE	3	3	9	0.5						bend arms to get 3 more reps to failure
45° LAT PULL DOWN	3	8-10	9	0.5						may do standing, exaggerated lean, wide grip to emphasis rear delts
SEATED CABLE ROW	3	10-12	9	0.5						v-bar grip attachment
DB REAR DELT FLYE	3	15-20	9	0.5						W-flye, backs of hands lead, elbows slightly bent
WINDSHIELD WIPERS	3	10-12	9	0.5						either hanging or on roman chair (ab/oblique exercise)

take last set to failure

day three

	SETS	REPETITIONS	RPE	REST	1	2	3	4	5	NOTES
SQUAT PRESS (OR LEG PRESS)	4	10-12	9	0.5						feet high on platform, wide stance, patience on concentric
CABLE SQUAT PULL THROUGH	2	10-12	9	0.5						warm up - patience on concentric, glutes move the weight, work the resistance up
	3	12-15	9	1.0						as above + 1 sec maximum contraction iso-hold at "lock-out"
A1. CABLE GLUTE KICKBACK	4	18-20	9	0.0						torso parallel to ground, if hamstrings too weak, strap around knee
A2. MACHINE HIP ABDUCTION	4	30	9	1.0						standing or seated
ROMAN CHAIR CALF RAISES		30		0.5						hold onto back of chair, lean hips back, push through pad of foot
OPTIONAL BRET'S GLUTE BURNOUT	3	1	10	0.0						https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=fouQIVcMVI4

day four

	SETS	REPETITIONS	RPE	REST	1	2	3	4	5	NOTES
MACHINE HORIZONTAL ROW	3	10-12	9	0.5						machine of choice
BRADFORD PRESS	3	10-14	9	1.0						https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GEk3HtY9dCg
ROPE CABLE ROW	3	10-12	9	1.0						cable at eye level, lunge back from cable machine
CABLE LATERAL RAISE	3	10-12	9	1.0						step 1 foot out from machine, cable in front of body
SINGLE-ARM BENT-OVER REAR DELT FLY	3	12-15	9	0.5						cable machine
A1. LYING LEG RAISE	3	10-12	9	0.0						extend lower back to stretch abs before raising legs and then hips
A2. RUSSIAN TWIST	3	10-12	9	1.0						10 each side

take last set to failure

day five

	SETS	REPETITIONS	RPE	REST	1	2	3	4	5	NOTES
AMERICAN DEADLIFT	2	8	8	0.5						warm up, work the resistance up to working sets
	3	8-10	9	1.0						sit hips back, bend at the knees, contract glutes to lockout
PRELOADED BARBELL STEP UP	3	10-12	9	1.5						control the negative as best as possible - do not alt sides
CABLE PULL THROUGH	3	18-20	9	0.5						burn out sets
CABLE ROMANIAN DEADLIFT	3	12-15	9	0.5						set up stable box 6" from cable machine, use bicycle bar attachment
KNEELING LEG CURL	3	10-12	9	0.5						anteriorly tilt pelvis, curl out and away from body
V-UP	3	10-12	9	0.5						
SIDE CRUNCH	3	10-12	9	0.5						each side

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day one

	SETS	REPETITIONS	RPE	REST	1	2	3	4	5	NOTES
BACK SQUAT	2	6-8	7	1.0						wider than shoulder width stance, slight foot flare
	4	8-10	9	1.5						focus on ext. rotating at the hips on descent and ascent
PRELOADED BARBELL RDL	4	12-15	9	1.0						use straps if grip is limiting
PRELOADED BARBELL WALKING LUNGE	3	18-20	9	1.5						short strides, low bar or lean forward, all weight onto forward step
CABLE GLUTE KICKBACK	3	12-15	9	1.0						torso parallel to ground, if hamstrings too weak, strap around knee
SINGLE LEG PRONE LEG CURL	3	8-10	9	0.5						8 each leg, 8 both legs
LYING LEG RAISE	3	10-12	10	0.5						hold onto bench behind head for stability
SEATED CALF PRESS MACHINE	3	30	10	0.5						10 toes in, 10 parallel, 10 toes out, push thru pads of feet

take last set to failure

day two

	SETS	REPETITIONS	RPE	REST	1	2	3	4	5	NOTES
SEATED INCLINE PRESS	4	8-10	9	1.0						dumbbell or machine, your choice
A1. DB LATERAL RAISE	4	12	9	0.5						arms slightly bent, avoid shrugging
A2. BENT ARM DB LATERAL RAISE	4	3	9	0.5						bend arms to get 3 more reps to failure
45° LAT PULL DOWN	4	8-10	9	0.5						may do standing, exaggerated lean, wide grip to emphasis rear delts
SEATED CABLE ROW	3	10-12	9	0.5						v-bar grip attachment
DB REAR DELT FLYE	3	15-20	9	0.5						W-flye, backs of hands lead, elbows slightly bent
WINDSHEILD WIPERS	3	10-12	9	0.5						either hanging or on roman chair (ab/oblique exercise)

take last set to failure

day three

	SETS	REPETITIONS	RPE	REST	1	2	3	4	5	NOTES
SQUAT PRESS (OR LEG PRESS)	4	10-12	9	0.5						feet high on platform, wide stance, patience on concentric
CABLE SQUAT PULL THROUGH	2	10-12	9	0.5						warm up - patience on concentric, glutes move the weight, work the resistance up
	4	12-15	9	1.0						as above + 1 sec maximum contraction iso-hold at "lock-out"
A1. CABLE GLUTE KICKBACK	4	18-20	9	0.0						torso parallel to ground, if hamstrings too weak, strap around knee
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BRADFORD PRESS	4	10-14	9	1.0						https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GEk3HtY9dCg
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CABLE LATERAL RAISE	3	10-12	9	1.0						step 1 foot out from machine, cable in front of body
SINGLE-ARM BENT-OVER REAR DELT FLY	3	12-15	9	0.5						cable machine
A1. LYING LEG RAISE	3	10-12	9	0.0						extend lower back to stretch abs before raising legs and then hips
A2. RUSSIAN TWIST	3	10-12	9	1.0						10 each side

take last set to failure

day five

	SETS	REPETITIONS	RPE	REST	1	2	3	4	5	NOTES
AMERICAN DEADLIFT	2	8	8	0.5						warm up, work the resistance up to working sets
	4	8-10	9	1.0						sit hips back, bend at the knees, contract glutes to lockout
PRELOADED BARBELL STEP UP	4	10-12	9	1.5						control the negative as best as possible - do not alt sides
CABLE PULL THROUGH	3	18-20	9	0.5						burn out sets
CABLE ROMANIAN DEADLIFT	3	12-15	9	0.5						set up stable box 6" from cable machine, use bicycle bar attachment
KNEELING LEG CURL	3	10-12	9	0.5						anteriorly tilt pelvis, curl out and away from body
V-UP	3	10-12	9	0.5						
SIDE CRUNCH	3	10-12	9	0.5						each side